

cially stated that the lords of the kingdom and army were with him (probably under his supervision) in Akkad, it seems highly probable that he was a very important personage in the government, a theory which is strengthened by the fact that his father, Nabonidus,* was more of an archæologist than a ruler, and far more interested in the discovery of a forgotten site than in the affairs of his kingdom. *Belšaruçur*, therefore, as some critics have argued,¹⁵ may have really been co-regent; but, as will be seen subsequently, the author of the Book of Daniel could not, as they thought, have had this idea in mind in calling him king of Babylon.

Comparing the *Belšaruçur* of the inscriptions with Belshazzar of the Book of Daniel, the following important differences are apparent. The former was the son of the last king of Babylon, but never reigned except possibly as co-regent, while the latter is distinctly called the last king and the son of Nebuchadnezzar. There can be little doubt that both of these statements were made by the author of Daniel in perfect good faith. A number of commentators¹⁶ have sought to prove that the Belshazzar of the Book of Daniel was not necessarily meant by the author as the last king of Babylon, but was intended for Evilmerodach, son of Nebuchadnezzar; a view advanced in support of the statement in verse 2, that Belshazzar was the son of Nebuchadnezzar. Following this theory, some considered Belshazzar merely a secondary name. (So Zündel 'Daniel,' 26; Niebuhr 'Geschichte,' 30, etc.) It is difficult to understand, however,

¹⁵ Floigl, 'Cyrus und Herodot,' 24; Andreä, 'Beweis des Glaubens,' 1888, p. 249; Smith in the 'Dictionary of the Bible'; Meinhold, 'Dissertation,' 30, n. 2, etc.

¹⁶ So Marsham, 'Canon chron.,' 596 ff.; Conring, 'Advers. Chron.' c. 13; Harenberg, 'Dan.' ii. pp. 454 ff.; Hofmann, 'Die siebenzig Jahre des Jeremia und die siebenzig Jahrwochen des Daniel,' p. 44; Hävernicks, 'Neue kritische Untersuchungen,' pp. 72 ff.; M. v. Niebuhr, 'Geschichte Assurs und Babels,' p. 42.; Wolff in the 'Studien und Kritiken,' 1858, p. 684 note a.; Zündel, 'Daniel,' 33; Unger, 'Kyaxares und Astyages,' pp. 28, 29. Keil, 'Dan.' 145, although knowing of the discovery of the name in the inscriptions thought that the *Belšaruçur*, son of Nabonidus, of the inscriptions must have been named after Belshazzar-Evilmerodach son of Nebuchadnezzar! Quatremere in his 'Annales de la philosophie chrétienne,' 1838, (Migne, 'Dic. de la Bible,' ii. p. 30, note, 1845), advanced the theory in support of Jeremiah xxvii. 7, that Nabonidus, as an usurper, associated with himself Belshazzar,